

# University of Michigan

## Fall 2024 Instructor Report

### EECS 110-001: Discover CS

#### Madelyn Gatchel

30 out of 46 students responded to this evaluation.

#### Responses to University-wide questions about the course:

|                                                                                                                                                              | SA | A  | N  | D | SD | N/A | Your Median | School/College Median | Univ-Wide Median |
|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----|----|----|---|----|-----|-------------|-----------------------|------------------|
| This course advanced my understanding of the subject matter. (Q1631)                                                                                         | 19 | 8  | 1  | 0 | 1  | 0   | 4.7         | 4.5                   | 4.5              |
| My interest in the subject has increased because of this course. (Q1632)                                                                                     | 14 | 8  | 5  | 1 | 1  | 0   | 4.4         | 4.2                   | 4.2              |
| I knew what was expected of me in this course.(Q1633)                                                                                                        | 16 | 9  | 1  | 2 | 1  | 0   | 4.6         | 4.4                   | 4.6              |
| I had a strong desire to take this course.(Q4)                                                                                                               | 13 | 14 | 2  | 0 | 0  | 0   | 4.4         | 4.1                   | 4.0              |
| As compared with other courses of equal credit, the workload for this course was (SA=Much Lighter, A=Lighter, N=Typical, D=Heavier, SD=Much Heavier). (Q891) | 1  | 8  | 13 | 7 | 0  | 0   | 3.1         | 2.9                   | 3.0              |

#### Responses to University-wide questions about the instructor:

|                                                                | SA | A | N | D | SD | N/A | Your Median | School/College Median | Univ-Wide Median |
|----------------------------------------------------------------|----|---|---|---|----|-----|-------------|-----------------------|------------------|
| Madelyn Gatchel seemed well prepared for class meetings.(Q230) | 23 | 5 | 0 | 0 | 1  | 0   | 4.9         | 4.7                   | 4.8              |
| Madelyn Gatchel explained material clearly.(Q199)              | 19 | 9 | 0 | 0 | 1  | 0   | 4.7         | 4.7                   | 4.7              |
| Madelyn Gatchel treated students with respect.(Q217)           | 22 | 6 | 1 | 0 | 0  | 0   | 4.8         | 4.8                   | 4.8              |

#### Responses to questions about the course:

|                                                                     | SA | A  | N | D | SD | N/A | Your Median |
|---------------------------------------------------------------------|----|----|---|---|----|-----|-------------|
| Overall, this was an excellent course. (Q1)                         | 16 | 11 | 1 | 0 | 1  | 0   | 4.6         |
| I felt included and valued when working with other students. (Q253) | 16 | 10 | 2 | 0 | 1  | 0   | 4.6         |

#### Responses to questions about the instructor:

|                                                         | SA | A | N | D | SD | N/A | Your Median |
|---------------------------------------------------------|----|---|---|---|----|-----|-------------|
| Overall, Madelyn Gatchel was an excellent teacher. (Q2) | 20 | 8 | 0 | 0 | 1  | 0   | 4.8         |

**This course maintained a good balance between Python instruction and non-coding components (e.g., guest speakers, interview assignment, industry tour).**

(custom question added by the instructor)

| SA | A  | N | D | SD | N/A | Your Median |
|----|----|---|---|----|-----|-------------|
| 15 | 10 | 3 | 1 | 0  | 0   | 4.5         |

**In this class, I learned about various ways to explore computer science at Michigan (e.g., interdisciplinary research, extracurriculars, minors, and majors).**

(custom question added by the instructor)

| SA | A  | N | D | SD | N/A | Your Median |
|----|----|---|---|----|-----|-------------|
| 16 | 10 | 2 | 0 | 1  | 0   | 4.6         |

**This class provided opportunities to learn about different computing-related career paths (e.g., software engineer, researcher, faculty member).**

(custom question added by the instructor)

| SA | A  | N | SD | D | N/A | Your Median |
|----|----|---|----|---|-----|-------------|
| 14 | 14 | 0 | 1  | 0 | 0   | 4.5         |

The medians are calculated from Fall 2024 data. University-wide medians are based on all UM classes in which an item was used. The school/college medians in this report are based on classes that are lower division with enrollment of 16 to 74 in College of Engineering.

## Written Comments

### Comment on the quality of instruction in this course. (Q900)

| Comments                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                           |
|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| I believe that Madelyn was an excellent instructor. She was very approachable and very helpful, and the course material introduced Python fairly clearly. Ena Maestry was not as great of an instructor. Her help often left me with more questions than answers and she seemed unequipped to instruct students.                                                                                                                   |
| Very high-quality material for beginners                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                           |
| I felt I could express my struggles and questions fully without ever being met with anything but openness and helpfulness by the teaching staff.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                   |
| I was satisfied with the level of instruction for this course. I liked Madelyn's emphasis on office hours, as her passion for the material was evident and she took the time to try and emphasize how important computer science is, as well as hone in on the key concepts throughout the semester, not only in office hours but during class as well.                                                                            |
| I thought it was very valuable to not only learn about basic code, but also to see what the industry is like through interviews and guest speakers.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                |
| The teachers were great and it was obvious that they cared deeply about their students' success and the subject matter as well, but it was difficult for me to keep up because the type of thinking required to be a coder is just so foreign to me. I felt like we went thru a lot of material quicker than I could comprehend it.                                                                                                |
| N/A                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                |
| The quality of instructions were great and the organizational aspect of canvas made it a lot easier to learn when I missed something in lecture.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                   |
| Great                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                              |
| The instructions were not too clear                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                |
| Very well organized and taught                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                     |
| I thought the quality pretty well for the most part. At times was very confused on homeworks/project.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                              |
| Overall, the quality of instruction in this course was excellent.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                  |
| Madelyn did an amazing job, I loved this class. It was very organized and I was able to learn a lot.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                               |
| good                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                               |
| Very good instructor, explained material clearly                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                   |
| Instructors are ethusiatic to offer me help and the teaching was clear and well-organized.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                         |
| I barely learned anything in this class and I had to teach myself everything. I feel like during the first half the teacher would teach us how to print a function, and in the next half she would ask us to code a game. Considering that it was an introductory course, we had no prior knowledge about how to do that. So then we had to rely on students who have a lot of experience with Python.                             |
| good                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                               |
| The quality of the instructions was very clear, and there was a lot of help always available, which was very comfortable to know. I was able to really feel that Madelyn was very excited and prepared for each class, which showed with her instructions given each class. She went at a study pace and made sure everyone understood what she was teaching.                                                                      |
| Super patient instructors                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                          |
| I enjoyed the course with my instructors and peers. Sometimes, I didn't understand the material, but I could go during office hours to get help and connect with my classmates. The physical classroom for group work can be better because it can be hard working with your classmates without space. However, I still enjoy how this course was taught, especially with meeting other people in the field and their exepriences. |

## What were the strengths of the course ? (Q953)

| Comments                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                        |
|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Very detailed lecture notes and labs that helped apply the material.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                            |
| It is not too easy, it helps people adjust to 280                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                               |
| I liked how it was not just programming and it was also a way to see other aspects of comp sci.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                 |
| I felt the class was engaging and really attempted to hone in on the fundamentals of computer science. It was a great class to understand the basics, coupled with a passionate instructor as well.                                                                                                                                                                             |
| The variety of instruction and group collaboration.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                             |
| Lots of opportunities for extra practice problems                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                               |
| N/A                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                             |
| I would definitely say the organization was really well thought out.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                            |
| Instructors are really caring and helpful                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                       |
| This course was relatively easy                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                 |
| Very diverse range of topics around CS. Very good entry level course.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                           |
| N/A                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                             |
| The extra-curricular activities (tours, interviews, etc.) made this class very engaging and interesting.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                        |
| The instructor explained the topics in an easy to understand way, and I liked the variety (guest speakers, activities, lectures...).                                                                                                                                                                                                                                            |
| easy for beginners                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                              |
| It was very easy to follow along during the lectures. I also appreciated the opportunity to tour Atomic Object.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                 |
| Learning Python. Doing the funny go fish project. Collaborating with classmates.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                |
| helpful                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                         |
| The help provided, Madelyn always made it clear that she was also ready to help whenever we ever helped with any work she provided to us. The assignments given to us were also helpful, and the notes/work we did in class was always uploaded by Madelyn which was also very helpful to look back at when doing the homework assignments.                                     |
| Quality of the instructors                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                      |
| The instructors were strengths because they ensured you had opportunities to get help and explain the material differently to understand. They made the content enjoyable for everyone. Another strength was the trips and meeting people within the field because they can provide experience and information for you to decide if you really want to pursue computer science. |

## What suggestions would you make for improving the course ? (Q955)

| Comments                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                  |
|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Perhaps provide more time to complete the in-class labs. I often found myself and others having to continue after class had ended to complete the assignment that was meant to be finished in class.                                                                                                                                                                      |
| More extra credit                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                         |
| I think it was pretty good as it is, and I liked how the final was split into a fun presentation and code.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                |
| I would focus the course more so on some aspects of coding and less on guest speakers. Computer science is such a vast field, and even though we are learning the basics, I believe that if we spent even more time on application/understanding as many unique concepts as possible, this class would improve.                                                           |
| N/A                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                       |
| More time spent on labs and coding rather than so many guest speakers and panels                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                          |
| N/A                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                       |
| N/A                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                       |
| N/A                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                       |
| The final project was rather difficult                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                    |
| More instruction and make the homework a bit easier to understand and do.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                 |
| I'd say take a more nuanced approach to explaining lessons. I felt at times we were just thrown into doing code assignments without a great instruction of how to actually do it.                                                                                                                                                                                         |
| Slightly more challenging assignments would do well in increasing Python understanding.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                   |
| more coding, less other stuff.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                            |
| I wish we had some time during class where we could meet with our homework partners. Not necessarily time to actually do the homework, but maybe just 5 minutes at the beginning or end of the class to meet them and schedule a time to work on the homework.                                                                                                            |
| Maybe make attendance mandatory so that all teammates will show up.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                       |
| kahoot was fun                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                            |
| The project seems to have functions that take in a lot of code, I think it would be more easier to approach and understand if there were many functions instead, that way the code would be easier to understand and organize. Although there were fewer functions to work on, it was a bit harder to understand how each one worked and the expected components of them. |
| The homework should be getting difficult step by steps and not suddenly jump in difficulty                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                |
| I would say either make the assignments simpler or add more class time to explain the content better because sometimes I didn't understand a homework assignment since we didn't cover the material in class, or it would differ from what we learned.                                                                                                                    |

## How might the class climate be made more inclusive of diverse students? (Q910)

| Comments                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                             |
|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| I feel that there is little that can be done to improve inclusivity. The class was very inclusive.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                   |
| It is already inclusive to diverse students.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                         |
| I think it was actually very inclusive of diverse students and that everyone was supported and encouraged to the same extent                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                         |
| I felt the class adequately represented all groups of students.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                      |
| N/A                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                  |
| not allow people with CS background to take this class; spend more time explaining material during lecture; walk thru practice problems together more                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                |
| N/A                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                  |
| N/A                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                  |
| N/A                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                  |
| NA                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                   |
| Dive into CS in different regions or areas such as women in CS etc.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                  |
| N/A                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                  |
| The class climate was already very inclusive of diverse students.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                    |
| have more space.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                     |
| I felt the class climate was already inclusive.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                      |
| N/A                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                  |
| —                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                    |
| I enjoyed taking this class with you Madelyn:) thank you                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                             |
| Madelyn had a very caring and helpful attitude towards everyone, and I think this exact approach was perfect in making everyone feel welcome; although it may take a lot more energy to provide everyone with a lot of attention, I believe it's worth it in the end when it comes treating everyone equaling and at an elevated manner. Which is what Madelyn had. I think Madelyn being themselves is the right direction for how to treat others. |
| It already includes a range of diverse students                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                      |
| I don't know the answer to this, but just being encouraging and willing to work with the student can go a long way.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                  |